

OPPOSITION REPORT

Spain

UEFA Euro 2024 champions | 7 matches analysed

Opposition analysis by Muhammed Ashhar A, Performance Analyst

Tools: Nacsport (video coding) | StatsBomb event data | Python (mplsoccer)

Summary: how Spain play and how we can hurt them

Control

58% possession, 87% passing and 65% field tilt on average.

Wide threat

49% of final-third entries come down their left, 37% down the right and only 14% centrally.

Selective press

PPDA 15.2 and 22 high regains per match. Short build-up is risky.

Vulnerable without the ball

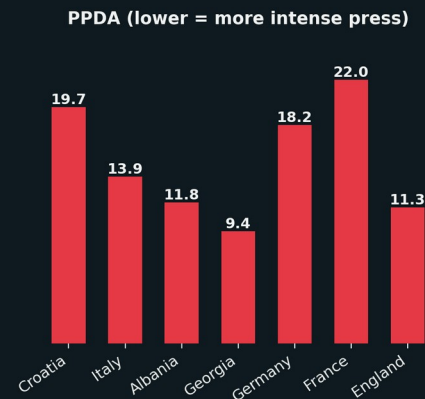
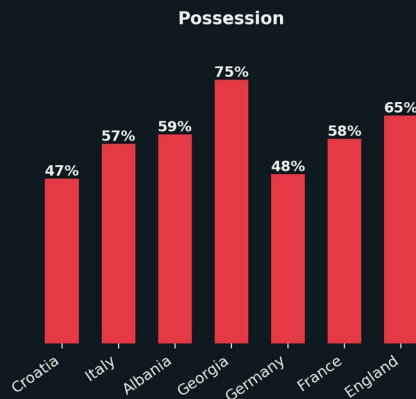
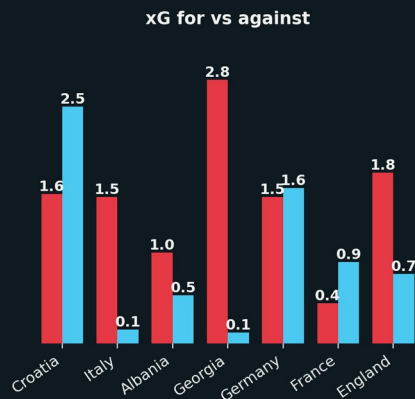
1.65 xG conceded per match when their press dropped (PPDA above 18), vs 0.37 otherwise.

7 wins from 7, built on control

Match-by-match xG, possession and pressing intensity

Spain match by match, Euro 2024

Red = Spain, blue = opponent | 7 matches: 7W 0D 0L (90/120 min)



Data: StatsBomb Open Data | Euro 2024

15-4

Goals for and against

10.6 - 6.4

xG for and against

123 - 75

Shots for and against

5 of 7

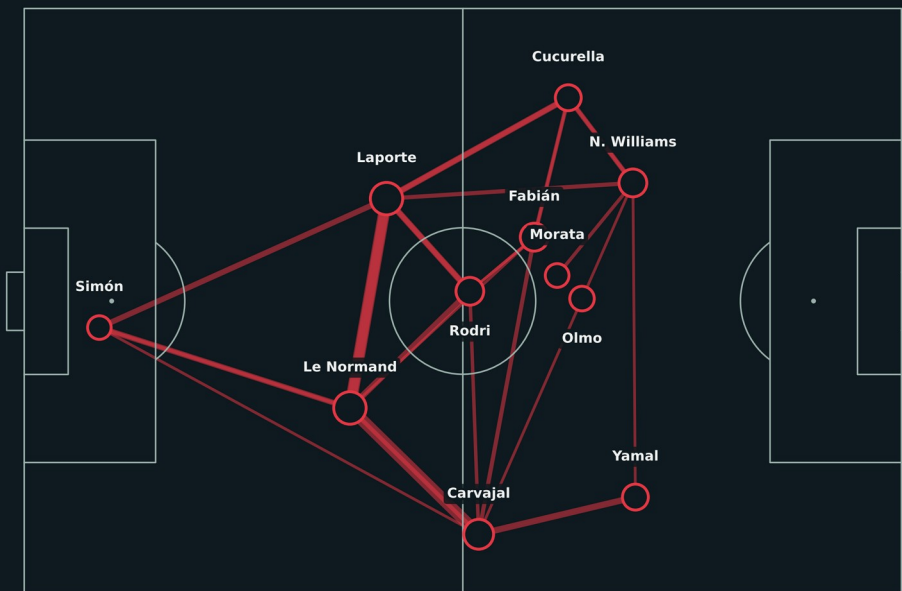
Matches in 4-2-3-1

Shape and build-up: 4-2-3-1 with high full-backs

Pass network, final vs England (before first substitution)

Spain pass network: Final vs England

Completed passes before the first substitution (min 45) | lines = 4+ passes | node = involvement



Data: StatsBomb Open Data | Euro 2024

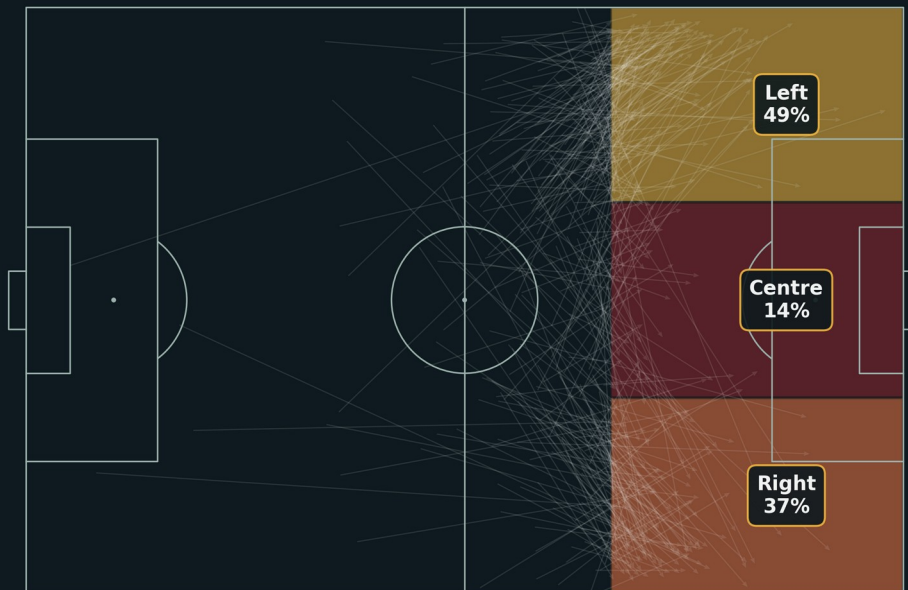
- Rodri and Fabián Ruiz form the double pivot; the build-up runs through Laporte, Le Normand and Rodri.
- Cucurella pushes high on the left, freeing Nico Williams to go 1v1.
- Yamal stays wide on the right with Carvajal behind him.
- Olmo floats between the lines as the No.10.

They attack down the flanks, mostly the left

334 completed passes into the final third

Build-up: how Spain enter the final third

334 completed passes into the final third, 7 matches | share by channel (their left = top)



49%

Entries down their left (Nico, Cucurella)

37%

Entries down their right (Yamal, Carvajal)

14%

Entries through the centre

Plan: protect both flanks and keep the middle compact.

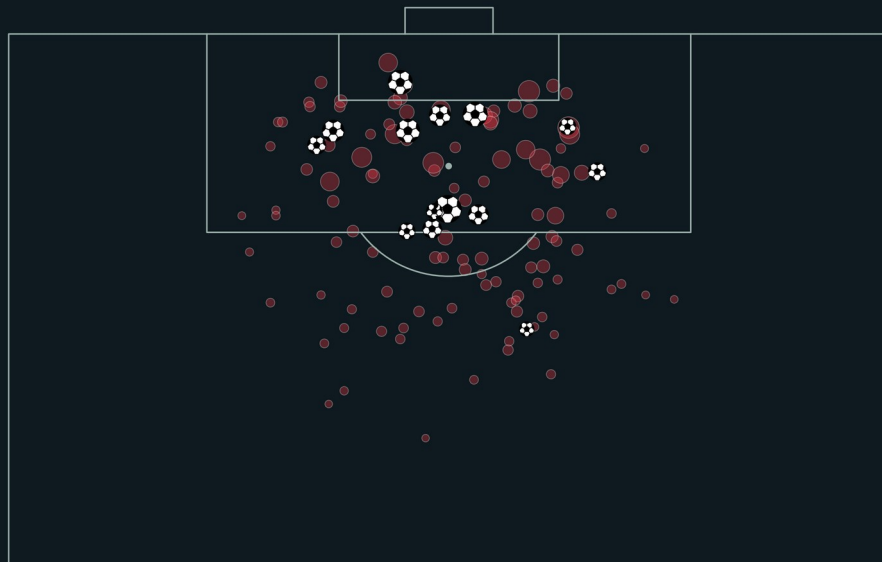
Data: StatsBomb Open Data | Euro 2024

Chances come from central zones in the box

123 shots, 10.6 xG, 14 goals from shots

Spain: shots, Euro 2024

123 shots | 10.6 xG | 14 goals (football markers) | size = xG



Data: StatsBomb Open Data | Euro 2024

- Most shots are taken inside the box, between the posts.
- Average shot quality 0.09 xG: they work the ball into good positions rather than shooting from range.
- Defend the six-yard box and the penalty spot area; track late runners like Olmo and Fabián Ruiz.

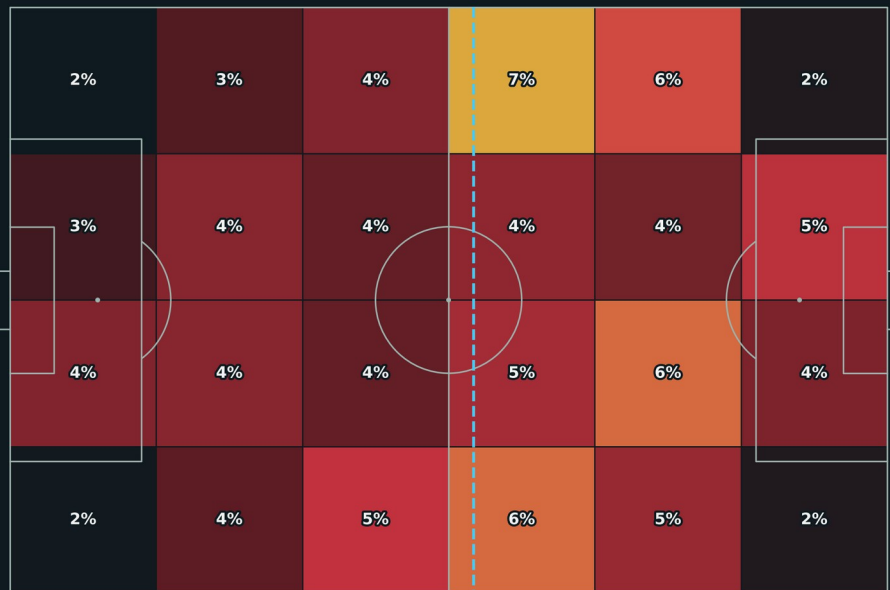
Pressing: selective, but sharp when it triggers

Share of Spain defensive actions by zone

Pressing: where Spain win and contest the ball

1,784 pressures, tackles, recoveries and interceptions | 34% in the attacking third

Average height: 63 m from own goal



Data: StatsBomb Open Data | Euro 2024

15.2

Average PPDA

22

High regains per match

34%

Defensive actions in the attacking third

Plan: avoid slow short build-up; play beyond the first line.

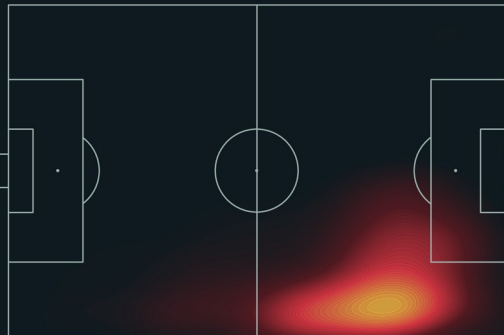
Key threats

Where they receive and act, plus tournament output

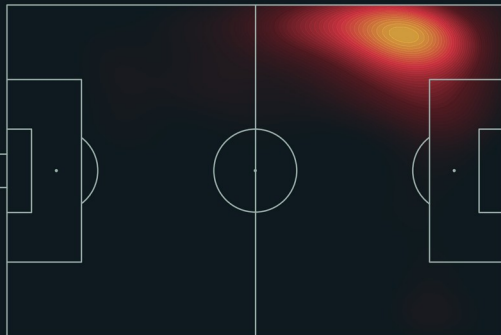
Key threats: where they receive and act

All on-ball actions in the selected matches | Spain attack left to right

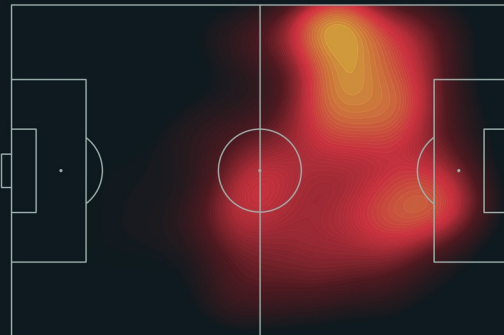
Lamine Yamal



Nico Williams



Daniel Olmo



Data: StatsBomb Open Data | Euro 2024

Player	Goals	xG	xA	Key passes	Prog. carries	Dribbles
Lamine Yamal	1	1.59	2.15	18	45	12
Daniel Olmo	3	1.38	1.24	11	17	10
Fabián Ruiz	2	1.14	1.17	11	11	7
Nico Williams	2	0.95	1.23	12	32	15
Álvaro Morata	1	1.57	0.34	3	8	1

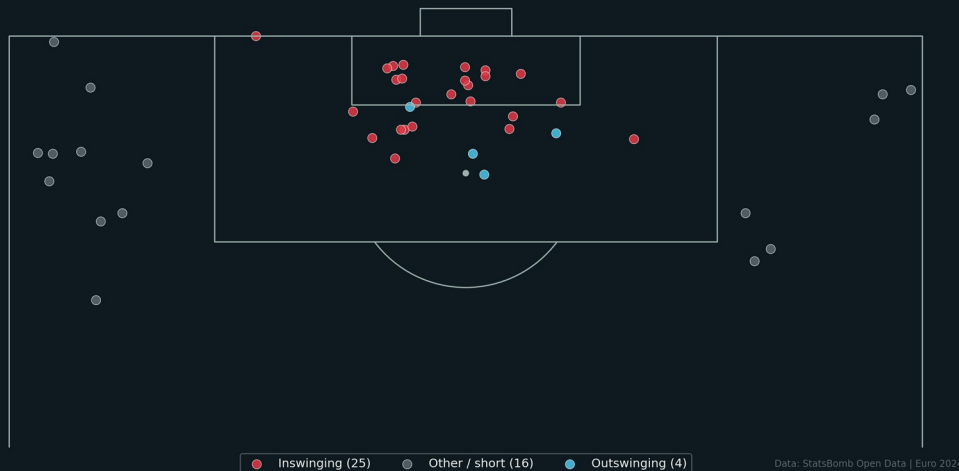
Data: StatsBomb Open Data | Euro 2024 | Non-confidential sample

Set pieces: inswinging corners to the six-yard box

45 corners analysed

Set pieces: Spain corner deliveries

45 corners | 35 shots and 3.2 xG from corner/free-kick phases



25 of 45

Corners delivered inswinging

35 shots, 3.2 xG

From corner and free-kick phases

3

Goals from set-piece phases

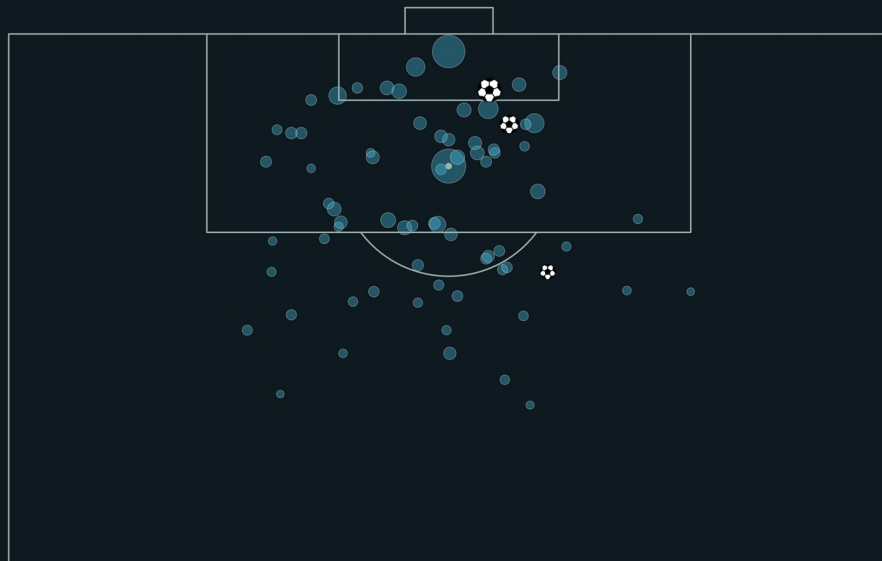
Plan: zone the six-yard box and near post; man-mark Laporte and Le Normand.

Where Spain are vulnerable

Shots conceded across the tournament

Spain's opponents: shots, Euro 2024

75 shots | 6.4 xG | 3 goals (football markers) | size = xG



Data: StatsBomb Open Data | Euro 2024

1.65 vs 0.37

xG conceded per match: low press (PPDA 18+) vs others

- Croatia (2.48 xG) and Germany (1.63 xG) hurt Spain when possession was close to 50/50.
- When games become open and less controlled, Spain concede far more chances.
- Compete for the ball and play quickly in transition rather than sitting deep for 90 minutes.

Game plan

1

Protect the flanks

Double up on Nico Williams and Yamal: full-back plus winger, show them inside.

2

Stay compact centrally

Force play wide early; defend crosses and cut-backs into the six-yard area.

3

Break their control

Press Rodri and the centre-backs in short, planned spells to deny rhythm.

4

Play beyond the press

Avoid slow short build-up; attack the space behind their high full-backs.

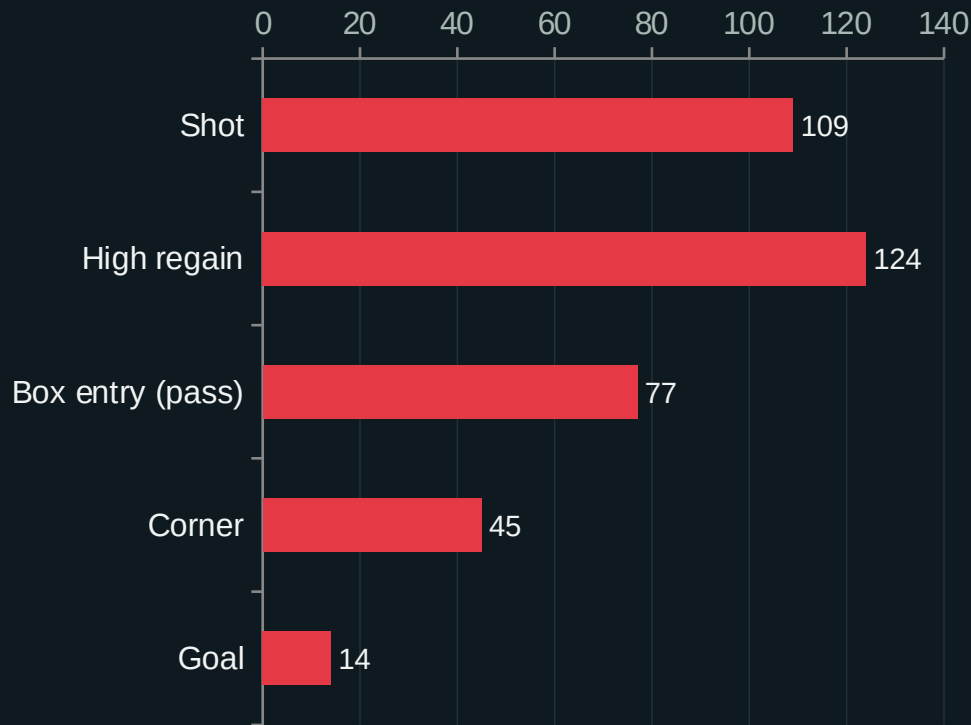
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Set pieces

Zonal six-yard box and near post for inswinging corners; mark the centre-backs.

Video plan: clips for the team meeting

369 timecoded moments to code and cut in Nacsport



- Playlists by phase: build-up, final-third entries, chance creation, pressing, transitions, set pieces.
- 6-10 clips per playlist, drawn with arrows and zones.
- 2-3 minute key-threat reels for Yamal, Nico Williams and Olmo.
- Clip list and code window template included with this report.